

The One Hundred and Eight Names of the Noble Ākāśagarbha, Together with Dhāraṇī and Mantra

Ārya Kha Garbha Aṣṭottaraśataka Nāma Dhāraṇī Mantra Sahita · Toh 636 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ནམ་མཁའ་སྒྲི་པའི་མཆན་བརྒྱ་མར་དྲུག་པ་གཟུགས་སྒྲས་དང་བཅས་པ་

Toh 636 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Kha Garbha Aṣṭottaraśataka Nāma Dhāraṇī Mantra Sahita, and in Tibetan as the One Hundred and Eight Names of the Noble Ākāśagarbha Together with Dhāraṇī and Mantra — Ākāśagarbha meaning "Essence of Space," one of the great bodhisattvas of the Mahāyāna tradition. The text consists of one hundred and eight names of this bodhisattva, accompanied by dhāraṇī and mantra, and is dedicated to the purpose of dispelling the suffering of beings and protecting them from evil destinies and lower rebirths. It belongs to the dhāraṇī class of canonical scriptures, a category of texts in which sacred names, syllables, and incantations are held to carry powerful spiritual efficacy when recited. Notably, the colophon as preserved associates the text with Maitreya rather than Ākāśagarbha, suggesting some ambiguity in transmission, though the body of the text is consistently devoted to Ākāśagarbha and opens with homage to that bodhisattva.

The one hundred and eight names of the noble Maitreya (Skt. Maitrī), together with dhāraṇī and mantra, for the purpose of dispelling the suffering of beings, are here completely set forth and concluded.

In the Indian language: Ārya Kha Garbha Aṣṭottaraśataka Nāma Dhāraṇī Mantra Sahita. In the Tibetan language: The One Hundred and Eight Names of the Noble Ākāśagarbha (the Essence of Space), together with Dhāraṇī and Mantra.

Homage to the noble Ākāśagarbha, whose face is broad and vast, whose eyes radiate light, and who makes the midst of space fragrant and sweet.

Homage to the one whose domain is space, who illuminates all the maṇḍalas of the earth.

Oṃ svastika mālikṣi vipula saṃbhava dharmādhātu gocara svāhā.

The moment this dhāraṇī is recited, all evil destinies and all lower rebirths are completely pacified. The earth shakes. The sound of great drums resounds. And all buddhas bestow their "Excellent!" upon it.

Then the Blessed One Vairocana declared: "O sentient beings gathered in the surrounding maṇḍala, listen! This, which is the supreme dhāraṇī of the svāhā of the manifest maṇḍala of the very essence of Ākāśagarbha, is exceedingly difficult to encounter. It is of great merit. It burns away all sins and mental afflictions. It is the mother of all bodhisattvas. It has become a mass of jewels. Hear it now, and upon hearing it one will become stainless, as though perfectly bathed and thoroughly purified.

One will become like a lotus: unstained by the mud of saṃsāra. One will become like the sun: illuminating all sentient beings. One will become like the moon: bringing deep satisfaction to all sentient beings. One will become like the sky: untouched by all the sufferings of the lower destinies. One will become like the earth: without high or low. One will become like Mount Meru: impossible for any sentient being to move. One will become like liberation: unstained by pleasure and pain.

And thus one will come to attain countless immeasurable qualities numbering in the hundreds of thousands, and so on. By merely hearing, holding, reading, reciting, teaching, and even just chanting this, whatever one may wish — all one's desires, aspirations, and hopes will be fulfilled.

Moreover, by merely chanting it, one will be fully protected from excessive rain, from drought, from disturbances caused by enemies, from human disease, from bad dreams, from harm, from times of ruin, from death, from thieves, from desolation, from warfare, from wild beasts, and from the suffering of famine. And all happiness, abundance, whatever one desires and whatever one delights in will come to be accomplished."

Then all those members of the assembly cried out "Ha, ha!" with great rejoicing and jubilation, exclaiming "Excellent!" They stirred, waving their robes and various ornaments, and from their hearts they bowed in homage. Then they recited the ocean of praise — a true and vast ocean of eulogy of the one hundred and eight names of the noble Ākāśagarbha, who is sovereign over all bodhisattvas:

Ākāśagarbha, supreme among sentient beings in the three realms of existence,
possessed of wealth, intelligence, and an ocean of precious wisdom.
The purest of sentient beings, the unsurpassed supreme jewel,
the seed of liberation, dispeller of the sufferings of saṃsāra.

Knowing all, knowing what is right, knowing the good and the not-good,
knowing liberation, knowing the Dharma, knowing happiness and suffering,
knowing the path, knowing what is precious, knowing the virtuous and the
non-virtuous,
knowing the times, knowing the wholesome, knowing strength and what is not
strength.

The supreme being, the supreme Dharma, the supreme quality of sentient
beings,
the supreme path, the supreme mantra, the supreme and the not-supreme of
conduct,
the supreme ornament, the supreme Dharma, the supreme of what is held and
what is not held.

The supreme of purity, the supreme of realization, the supreme of the
supreme and the not-supreme,
the foremost of peace, the foremost of compassion, the foremost of the
retinue,
the foremost of light, the foremost of liberation, the foremost of what is relied
upon,
the foremost of extent, the foremost of mantra, the foremost of loving care,
the foremost of equanimity, the foremost of sentient beings, the foremost of
knowing the three.

The lamp of excellence, the supreme lamp, the lamp of strength and of what is
not strength,
the lamp of liberation, the lamp of lineage, the lamp of the victorious and the
not-victorious,
the lamp of virtue, the lamp of splendor, the lamp of the jewel's light,
the lamp that has risen from the ornament of the stars and the moon,
the supreme light, the ray of light that is the light of all qualities,
the excellent light, the light of the palace of liberation, the light of what is
relied upon,
the great light, the light that thoroughly dispels delusion,
the blazing vajra light, the bearer of the light of bliss.

The lord of the vajra (vajra), the lord who leads, the lord of sentient beings,
the sovereign adorned with the maṇḍala of the jewel's radiance,
the sovereign of victors, the endless stream of power of the Victors, the
boundless sovereign,

the hero, the sovereign who holds the vidyā-mantra, the sovereign of the three realms.

The excellent vajra, the light of the vajra, the blazing vajra,
the vajra-sattva, adorned with the blazing of the vajra,
the vajra of light, the holder of the vajra, the mighty vajra,
the vast vajra, the vajra of supreme excellence and sovereignty.

Clad in blue, the vesture of the body is blue,
the body's complexion is blue, adorned with blue radiance.
A sharp-edged sword, blue and steady, is borne aloft,
dwelling within the blazing, boundless blue-sky palace.

The divine face, stainless and blazingly intense beyond bearing,
supremely fierce, with rays of light radiating and transforming.
Bearing a supreme garland that stirs sins like dust,
standing firm and graceful in the splendor of lightning's power.

Armed with sword and weapon, endowed with sovereignty, displaying might
and strength,
armed with a vajra weapon, awesome with arrows and short spears,
armed with a discus weapon, seemingly riding amid mountains in swirling
motion,
armed with a shining weapon, crushing the power of obstructors.

The source of bliss, lord of the three worlds, wielding the vajra club,
all his bodies adorned with the light of the sun.
Having arisen in a renowned lineage, he performs the role of king,
made graceful and beautiful by a garland of pearls.

Having attained a beauteous form, having attained excellence in abundance,
having attained the supreme of the vast expanse, having attained entry into
the grounds,
having attained superior power, having attained accomplishment,
having attained the power of the three knowledges, having attained might.

He who leads to bliss, leads to peace, and leads in light,
leads in the radiance of the most excellent vesture, and leads the great
renown,
leads in loving-kindness, leads as the sun, and leads all living beings,
leads excellently, leads the power of the realm, and is possessed of

compassion.

Stainless in vesture, clear in vesture, blazing in vesture,
he bears the banner of fame and of renowned elegance.

Knowing the opening of the way for beings, knowing approach and withdrawal,
he enters with a mind that clearly shows prosperity.

The red body, the tall body, the beautiful body, the excellent body,
the golden body, the white body, the body of great renown.

The playful body, the vajra body, the lord body, the fine-eyed body,
the lineage body, the holder of the vidyā-mantra, bearing the jewel.

The crown-jewel, possessing the crown, the supreme diadem,
wearing the diadem, holding the Dharma, the supreme vajra,
the glorious bearer, holding the supreme precious treasure,
holding the mantra-ground mudrā, in full and perfect excellence.

Supremely beautiful, traveling through the sky and roaming freely,
sole sun of the three realms, possessing a thousand lights,
the auspicious one risen at the mountain's summit, spreading well and
propitious,
renowned in qualities, might, and distinctive power.

The great jewel, the lovely jewel, the jewel's light,
the solar jewel, the jewel of pure conduct, the blazing jewel,
the wish-fulfilling jewel, the sole protector of all beings,
the single jewel shining in the midst of the sky.

The pure sentient beings, vast and widely renowned,
the sole guardian of the three realms, the supreme child of the Victors,
peaceful, supremely peaceful, ever worthy of refuge,
lord of living beings, born from the lotus, lotus-born.

Possessed of light excellent on all sides, holding the Dharma of excellent
speech,
the excellent speech of renown, the excellent speech of supreme discipline,
the salutation of excellent speech,
excellent in mind, excellent in radiance, possessed of bliss, excellent in
birthplace,
supremely wise, supremely peaceful, endowed with the supreme Dharma.

The maker of peace, the arising of the victorious, the abode from which bliss
arises.

The source of light, the maker of bliss, the lord of sovereignty.
The source from which excellence arises, the source of wisdom, the arouser of power.
The source of compassion, of noble mind, the maker of far-reaching fame.
The mind of liberation, of definite liberation, of supreme liberation.
The vast mind, perfectly spread abroad and perfectly renowned,
the gateway to universal enjoyment, the supreme of minds.
Steadfast in wisdom, accomplished through the Three Jewels.
A buddha whose face is like the wide-open petals of a lotus,
pure, broad-eyed, pleasing in deportment.
The essence that is luminous at its heart, stable and tamed.
Attaining continuity by essential nature, supremely radiant.
Possessing a corner of the eye supremely gracious to bestow,
a fearless countenance like the moon of the Teacher.
Possessed of the supreme weapon, the weapon complete with a hundred short lances.
Fierce and terrifying, born from the three removers of evil.
Supremely tamed, delighting in the company of the wise, easy to befriend.
Supremely fierce, yet supremely kind, of golden hue.
The Great God (Śiva), the maker of bliss, radiant, holding in hand,
three-eyed, possessing the three knowledges, dispelling the three fires.
Holding a beautiful flower, bearing a flowered arrow in hand,
clothed in fine garments, letting fly powerfully to the right, hurling with great force.
Beautifully drawn, possessing manifold weapons of various kinds,
the glory of manifold garments and manifold ornaments.
A countenance like the moon spreading its rays of light,
whose shining face enriches all the world.
With a smile that fully blazes with the rays of the sun,
a shining face that illumines the ocean, like a beacon on the path.
The great lord, whose thunderbolt hand rings with a terrifying sound,
holding a fierce vajra and a shaking jewel,
endowed with the power to make sound and echo appear as light.
Of great wisdom, of supremely sharp wisdom,
bearing ornaments, bearing glory, possessing a jeweled face.
The abode of all beings, moving and unmoving.
The Tathāgata, protector, a fine garland of sons.
Of great power, the essential nature of the wisdom of the world.

Lord of all beings, examining in accord with scripture.
The lord of humans, the cause that gives rise to the higher realms.
Like an illusion, bearing the arrow of desire and the vajra,
possessing power and strength, endowed with beautiful and lovely eyes.
The excellent Teacher, the foundation of the path of emptiness,
entering into the cause of increase of the three precious ones.
Firm, supremely certain with regard to the cause,
master of all sacred maṇḍalas.
Alone, knower of the ritual of the maṇḍala of all beings,
born from the realm of Vairocana.
Having received empowerment, perfectly dwelling on the ten grounds,
dwelling in a great place, proceeding to the supreme dwelling, uniquely so.
Dispelling the afflictions of sentient beings
and destroying evil — whoever recites these one hundred and eight epithets,
the supreme child of the Sugata, shines in the world
like a single moon rising.
Ākāśagarbha (the bodhisattva whose name means "Essence of Space"), sole
refuge of sentient beings —
whoever in the morning, seated before him, recites this hymn of praise,
that one becomes the supreme among sentient beings of the three realms
and is freed from every place of stain.
When war and strife utterly unbearable arise,
when the harm of famine and human disease breaks out,
whatever wise person rises early, generates faith,
and offers praise to Ākāśagarbha —
that one is freed from all sources of fear
and from evils that lead to suffering.
That one attains the supreme peace, the abode of supreme bliss,
and will assuredly obtain vast happiness.
Whether it be to attain bliss and flourishing enjoyment,
to obtain sovereignty, to acquire physical beauty and wealth,
or to attain noble birth and to establish the foundation of all good qualities —
if one recites this, it will be accomplished; of this there is no doubt.
Therefore, if one constantly desires all that is wished for and pleasant,
and for the sake of all beings one acts with courage —
Ākāśagarbha of the three realms —

Translator's Notes

- The opening colophon line "सुप्रसन्नोऽयं भगवन्" is a closing verse of the preceding text on Maitreya's one hundred and eight names, and the rendering "for the purpose of dispelling the suffering of beings, are here completely set forth" follows the most natural reading of the fragmentary verse context.

The phrase rendered "who makes the midst of space fragrant and sweet" reads literally "who makes the interior of space fragrant"; this is a characteristic epithet of Ākāśagarbha in his literature.

The list "knowing the supreme and the not-supreme of conduct" and "the supreme of what is held and what is not held" involves terse Tibetan formulaic verse; the renderings follow the grammatical structure faithfully, though the theological nuance of "held and not held" (འཇགས་པ་མེད་པ་འཇགས་པ་མེད་པ་) may refer to grasping versus non-grasping, which is doctrinally plausible in context.

- The passage is a dense stream of epithets and attributes in verse, characteristic of a tantra or praise-hymn to a vajra deity. The deity described — blue-bodied, bearing a sword, wielding the vajra, sovereign of the three realms, and surrounded by blazing light — is consistent with a form of Vajrapāṇi or a related wrathful vajra deity.

The phrase rendered "knowing the three" for 三三三 refers most likely to the three knowledges (of past, present, and future lives, and so forth), consistent with traditional buddha-epithets; this is clarified in the later line "having attained the power of the three knowledges."

The term 慈愛 (jizai) is rendered "foremost of loving care" — 慈愛 as a synonym for compassionate affection distinct from the technical 慈悲 (jizai).

The phrase पद्मोद्भवः (literally "lotus-arisen, lotus-born") appears to be a dual epithet; in context it evokes both purity of origin and an identification with Padmapāṇi or the lotus-born epithet common to pure arising.

- The figure referred to throughout the section beginning "The Great God, the maker of bliss, radiant, holding in hand, three-eyed" is Śiva described in his characteristic iconographic form: three-eyed, fire-dispelling, holding weapons, of golden hue. This passage is part of a longer litany of epithets for Ākāśagarbha that draws on divine imagery including Śaiva iconography to praise the bodhisattva. The line "born from the three removers of evil" is somewhat opaque; it likely refers to three purifying or destructive qualities traditionally associated with the deity's power to remove the three fires of affliction. The final line is syntactically incomplete in the source text, indicating the passage continues beyond what was supplied here.

Colophon

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spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.